

Product Decisions Ledger

Product thesis

A Zen Planner replacement for Muay Thai gyms and Hyrox/HIIT-style class studios, focused on: - usability - reliability - scheduling - billing - attendance - member self-service - migration confidence

Core value proposition

Help gyms move off clunky software to a calmer, easier operational system without losing their core data.

Primary differentiation

- better UX
- more reliable daily operations
- migration-friendly onboarding and import
- cleaner member self-service

Target customers

Primary ICP

- Muay Thai gyms
- Hyrox/HIIT-style class-based studios

Secondary fit

- one-location boutique class gyms with similar scheduling and billing needs

Not primary target for MVP

- multi-location groups
- franchise systems
- retail-heavy gyms
- enterprise chains

Product guardrails

MVP guardrails

- one location only
- web only for MVP
- owner, coach, customer roles only
- modular monolith
- Next.js + Postgres

- Stripe for payments
- email only at launch
- optional multiple rooms within one location

Explicitly deferred

- native iOS app
- native Android app
- multi-location support
- SMS
- push notifications
- public API
- integrations marketplace

User roles

Owner

Handles business setup, schedule, staff, billing policies, communication, migration approval, forms.

Coach

Handles roster, attendance, notes, substitute requests, member messaging, progress updates when enabled.

Customer

Handles booking, billing self-service, messaging staff, forms, progress viewing if enabled, freeze/cancel requests if allowed.

Front desk

No separate front-desk role in MVP. Coach role covers those workflows.

Business model and billing

Supported in MVP

- recurring monthly memberships
- drop-ins
- punch cards

Not supported in MVP

- weekly plans
- separate class packs outside punch cards

Cancellation behavior

- owner approval required
- effective at end of billing cycle
- gyms may require notice logic such as 2 months paid notice before final cancellation
- cancellation policy must be owner-configurable

Freeze behavior

- immediate and scheduled freezes supported
- owner approval required
- self-serve request optional and owner-controlled

Failed payment behavior

- grace period configurable by owner
- failed payment recovery queue required
- retry behavior supported
- payment update request supported

Refunds and credits

- partial refunds supported
- account credits supported
- owners control what credits can be used for

Drop-ins, punch cards, events, private lessons

Drop-ins

- paid at booking
- owner can enable/disable

Punch cards

- do not expire
- owner can enable/disable
- not shareable
- can be general or class-type-specific
- late cancel consumes a punch
- no-show consumes a punch
- members can buy them if enabled

Events

- prepaid only
- owner-configurable availability

Private lessons

- prepaid only
- visible in member portal
- coach assignment required
- owner-configurable availability

Scheduling and class operations

- recurring weekly schedule required
- one-off class edits supported
- recurring series edits supported
- class cancellation supported
- class rescheduling supported
- one location only
- multiple rooms supported if enabled
- class capacity limits supported
- waitlist supported
- booking cutoff rules supported
- cancellation cutoff rules supported
- substitute coach workflow required

Member portal

Included at launch

- browse classes
- book/cancel classes
- join waitlist
- view upcoming bookings
- view private lesson bookings
- buy drop-ins and punch cards if enabled
- view membership details
- view invoices and receipts
- update payment method
- message staff
- request freeze/cancel if enabled

Delivery model

- responsive web only for MVP
- native mobile after first 1–2 paying customers

Messaging and communications

Messaging scope

- 1:1 threads only
- staff-to-member and member-to-staff only
- parent and child context visible where relevant

Broadcasts

- owners can send broadcasts in MVP
- broadcasts also support email delivery

Email at launch

- trial confirmation
- booking confirmation
- class reminders
- failed payment notices
- announcements
- payment method update requests

Family model

Included in MVP

- one guardian can manage multiple children
- two guardians can link to one child
- guardian pays by default
- family shares payment method by default
- guardian books for child
- guardian can view child progress

Child upgrade path

- child account can be upgraded to regular student login on owner approval
- owner can generate signup link for child

Progress tracking

Scope

Optional module.

Supported model

- belts
- stripes

- promotion history

Stripe logic

- stripes are counted per current belt only

Visibility

- any gym can disable all progress UI
- product should not expose progress UI when disabled

Waivers, agreements, and forms

Required in MVP

- waiver
- membership agreement
- child/guardian waiver
- custom forms uploaded by owner

Signature model

- owners upload PDFs
- e-sign flow similar to DocuSign
- waiver and membership agreement are separate
- child/guardian waivers are separate

Versioning

- versioning required
- signed state tied to document version

Migration

Included in MVP

- Zen Planner path
- CSV fallback path

Migration expectation

If Zen Planner exposes it in export and it is relevant to operations, migrate it.

Data targeted for migration

- members
- guardians/family links
- memberships
- billing status

- next billing date
- punch-card balances/credits
- notes
- staff
- ranks/belts/stripes if used
- lifetime bookings
- lifetime attendance
- no-shows
- historical invoices
- receipts/payment history where available
- schedule/class templates if export allows

Invoice history behavior

- actionable records shown by default
- toggle for full historical invoices

Migration UX

- file upload
- field mapping
- validation
- duplicate detection
- missing data warnings
- preview
- dry-run/staging import
- final import
- reconciliation checklist

Migration principle

Do not promise perfect one-click migration. Provide guided, validated, reviewable migration.

Reporting

Included in MVP

- active members count
- trials count
- attendance by class
- failed payments count
- revenue collected summary
- new members count
- cancellations count

Deferred reporting

- advanced cohort retention

- deep financial analytics
- enterprise dashboards

Technical architecture

- modular monolith
- Next.js
- Postgres
- Stripe
- web only for MVP
- native mobile later
- optional modules should be cleanly disableable

MVP boundaries

Included

- workspace setup
- owner/coach/customer roles
- staff invites
- programs
- rooms
- recurring schedule
- class editing
- substitute coaches
- member profiles
- trial booking
- waivers/forms
- memberships
- drop-ins
- punch cards
- Stripe billing
- grace period config
- failed payment recovery
- credits
- partial refunds
- member portal
- class booking
- waitlist
- attendance
- email reminders
- events
- private lessons
- family support basics
- optional belt/stripe module
- Zen Planner/CSV migration
- migration preview/validation/reconciliation

Deferred

- native mobile apps
- SMS/push
- multi-location
- POS/retail
- advanced CRM/marketing automation
- advanced BI/reporting
- public API
- website builder
- payroll/commissions

Summary statement

This product is a one-location gym management platform for Muay Thai gyms and class-based fitness studios that handles scheduling, memberships, billing, attendance, member self-service, forms/signatures, and safe migration from Zen Planner.